

CELES CHAI JIA XUAN

+65 91905568 | celes.chai@u.nus.edu | celes.chai@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)



EDUCATION

National University of Singapore

Singapore

Bachelor of Computing in Computer Science

Jul 2023 – May 2027

- GPA: 4.55/5.00 | Member of NUS College (Honours)
- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Operating Systems, Parallel Programming, Object-Oriented Programming, Software Development Lifecycle, Media Computing and Signal Processing, Linear Algebra, Calculus, Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Operating Systems

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, Go
- **Web & Mobile Development:** React.js, Next.js, Express.js, RESTful APIs, Expo (iOS/Android), HTML, (Tailwind) CSS
- **Database & Cloud:** SQL, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, AWS (EC2, Lambda), Azure Speech Service, Docker
- **Hardware & Embedded:** Microcontrollers, Firmware Development, PCB Design, Logic Analyzers, Waveform Generators, Circuit Diagnostics
- **Other:** LaTeX, Matplotlib, Spring Security, Docker Compose, WinSCP, Task Scheduler, Git/GitHub, Integration Testing, PowerShell, VBA, Spring

WORK EXPERIENCE

Student Researcher – Embedded Systems, Networking, VLC

Jan 2025 – Nov 2025

WEISER Lab, National University of Singapore (Supervisor: Dr. Ambuj Varshney)

Singapore

- Prototyped hardware transmitter and receiver for visible light communication (VLC) research
- Designed duplex protocol for bidirectional communication, currently submitted to MobiCom conference
- Developed firmware for microcontrollers and device drivers for hardware component interfacing
- Applied error correction algorithms to improve transmission reliability across different conditions, achieving 0 bit error rate up to 250kpbs.
- Troubleshooted hardware issues using logic analyzers and waveform generators for signal analysis
- Presented and discussed mid-project findings to Dr. Ben Leong, receiving positive feedback on research direction and progress
- Created data visualizations using Matplotlib and documented research findings in LaTeX

Founding Engineer

Jun 2025 – Present

SakuraSpeak

Singapore

- Led product development and technical architecture decisions, implementing scalable systems using DynamoDB, Express.js, and AWS Lambda
- Designed familiarity scoring and recommendation algorithm, improving user engagement and retention through a spaced repetition system (SRS)
- Designed and implemented backend prompt-engineering pipelines for LLM integration, enabling automated user-level assessment, contextual understanding, and intelligent estimation of unavailable data
- Established technical standards, documentation, and processes to streamline future team onboarding and ensure operational consistency
- Integrated third-party APIs including Azure Speech Service and Kuromoji tokenization for user speech analysis
- Collaborated with co-founders through twice-weekly engineering meetings on strategic technical decisions and product roadmap
- Developed cross-platform mobile applications using Expo for iOS and Android deployment

Introduction to AI and Machine Learning Teaching Assistant

Aug 2025 – Nov 2025

NUS CS2109S

Singapore

- Delivered weekly tutorials on AI/ML concepts, guiding students through coding exercises, algorithms, and applied problem-solving.
- Graded assignments, analyzed common errors, and provided targeted feedback to improve student understanding of technical concepts.
- Incorporated survey feedback and performance metrics to iterate on instructional material for improved clarity and engagement.
- Developed and maintained AI/ML problem sets, collaborating with lead instructors to improve content clarity, and align assignments with course learning outcomes.

Cyber Transformation Intern

May 2024 – Aug 2024

KPMG

Singapore

- Conducted extraction and delivery of logs for Singapore's Government on Commercial Cloud migration project
- Demonstrated strong problem-solving skills by proposing and implementing PowerShell, Task Scheduler and VBA scripts to automate server maintenance, data extraction, and file management tasks
- Optimized processes through automation initiatives, completing log migration project originally requiring team of 4 alone within same timeframe
- Documented technical procedures and created comprehensive user guides for client support team handover

Vice President, Junior College Executive Committee

Apr 2021 – May 2022

Singapore Ministry of Education

Singapore

- Led team of 11 members, collaborating with MOE officers and managing project deliverables during pandemic
- Adapted escape room event to virtual format using Gather Town, expanded capacity and publicity reached 2000+ Instagram accounts
- Spearheaded VLog bank initiative preserving project impact, accumulating over 1900 views
- Facilitated sprint planning for virtual events

PROJECTS

VisibleBits

July 2025

- Developed proof-of-concept system completed with Li-Fi transmitter, receiver, driver, and transmission protocol
- Improved and implemented custom high power LED driver involving SMT soldering and PCB design
- Built receiver with transimpedance amplifier achieving data rates up to 1 Mbps with 0 BER at low light intensities
- Created "information spotlights" using Li-Fi's spatial confinement for location-aware content delivery in museums/retail
- Implemented duplex communication protocol with CRC error checking and BLE-based acknowledgments for reliability

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **ASEAN Undergraduate Merit Scholarship** – Covers full subsidised undergraduate tuition fees plus S\$5,800 annual living allowance, S\$3,000 annual accommodation allowance, and a one-time S\$1,750 computer grant.
- **REx Research Grant** – Awarded up to S\$2,500 to support research expenses by NUS Office of the Deputy President and Provost.
- **ASEAN Scholarship for Pre-University** – Covers annual allowance with hostel accommodation, settling-in allowance, return travel for Malaysians, school and GCE A-Level exam fees, plus subsidised medical and accident insurance.

LANGUAGES

English (Native/Bilingual), Chinese (Native/Bilingual), Malay (Fluent)